Humana. Claims Payment Policy

Subject: Laboratory – Fecal Analysis in the Diagnosis of Intestinal Dysbiosis

Application: Medicare Advantage Products

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Medicare Advantage Payment Policy

As a Medicare Advantage plan, we have developed payment policies to explain coverage more fully for services. The criteria outlined will apply to Medicare Advantage plans except when the procedure(s) has established criteria through the Original Medicare National Coverage Determinations (NCDs) and Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs) as outlined below.

In addition to the policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.

- Analysis of the following components **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE** for the evaluation of intestinal dysbiosis, irritable bowel syndrome, malabsorption or small intestinal overgrowth of bacteria:

  - Aerobic bacterial culture (CPT code 87077)
  - Anaerobic bacterial culture (CPT code 87076)
  - Beta-glucoronidase (CPT code 84311)
  - Cholesterol (CPT code 82715)
  - Chymotrypsin (CPT code 84311)
  - Fecal secretory immunoglobulin A (IgA) (CPT code 82784)
  - Identification or quantitation of fecal yeast (CPT code 87102, CPT code 87106)
  - Iso-butyrate, iso-valerate and n-valerate (CPT code 82542)
  - Long chain fatty acids (CPT code 82542, CPT code 82725)
  - Meat or vegetable fibers (CPT code 89160)
  - N-butyrate (CPT code 82542)
  - Potential of hydrogen (pH) (CPT code 83986)
  - Short chain fatty acid distribution (CPT code 82542)
  - Total short chain fatty acids (CPT code 82542)
  - Triglycerides (CPT code 82710)

Applicable procedures for Medicare Advantage plans

Procedure code	Code description
82542	Column chromatography, includes mass spectrometry, if performed (eg, HPLC, LC, LC/MS, LC/MS-MS,GC, GC/MS-MS, GC/MS, HPLC/MS), non-drug analyte(s) not elsewhere specified, qualitative or quantitative, each specimen
82710	Fat or lipids, feces; quantitative
82715	Fat differential, feces, quantitative
82725	Fatty acids, nonesterified
82784	Gammaglobulin (immunoglobulin); IgA, IgD, IgG, IgM, each

Procedure code	Code description
83986	pH; body fluid, not otherwise specified
84311	Spectrophotometry, analyte not elsewhere specified
87076	Culture, bacterial; anaerobic isolate, additional methods required for definitive identification, each isolate
87077	Culture, bacterial; aerobic isolate, additional methods required for definitive identification, each isolate
87102	Culture, fungi (mold or yeast) isolation, with presumptive identification of isolates; other source (except blood)
87106	Culture, fungi, definitive identification, each organism; yeast
89160	Meat fibers, feces

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